

**State of Vermont
Secretary of State
Office of Professional Regulation
Board of Allied Mental Health Practitioners**

In re: Steven Quintiliani

License No. 068.0130879 & 100.0131078

Docket No. 2026-23

STIPULATION AND CONSENT ORDER

STIPULATION

NOW COMES the State of Vermont, by and through Prosecuting Attorney Zoe Newman, and Respondent Steven Quintiliani, by and through his counsel Ed Adrian, Esq., who hereby stipulate and agree as follows:

Board Authority

1. The Vermont State Board of Allied Mental Health Practitioners (the Board) has authority to issue warnings or reprimands; suspend, revoke, limit, or condition current licenses; or prevent the renewal of lapsed licenses if, after a disciplinary hearing, the Board finds that the Respondent has engaged in unprofessional conduct. 3 V.S.A. § 129(a); 3 V.S.A. §129a; 3 V.S.A. §814(d); 26 V.S.A. Chapter 78; the Administrative Rules of the Board of Allied Mental Health Practitioners; and the Rules of the Office of Professional Regulation (OPR).

Alleged Facts

2. Steven Quintiliani (Respondent), of New Haven, Vermont, is licensed as a Licensed Clinical Mental Health Counselor (LCMHC) under license number 068.0130879, which was first issued by the State of Vermont, on June 16, 2017, and expires on January 31, 2027.
3. Respondent is also licensed as a Licensed Marriage and Family Therapist (LMFT) under license number 100.0131078, which was first issued on June 16, 2017, and expires on November 20, 2026.
4. Respondent is further licensed as a Licensed Alcohol and Drug Abuse Counselor (LADAC) license under license number 151.0130877, which was first issued by the State of Vermont on February 27, 2018, and expires on January 31, 2027.
5. Between September 2019 and January 2025, Respondent was employed as an Adult Addiction Recovery Clinician by a counseling agency (Agency), in Addison County, Vermont.
6. Despite the title of Adult Addiction Recovery Clinician, Respondent's caseload included individuals seeking mental health counseling unrelated to substance use.

7. At some point in Respondent's employment by the Agency and before April 2023, C.G. became Respondent's supervisor.
8. On November 13, 2024, during a supervision meeting with C.G., Respondent informed C.G. that he had created a treatment plan for an unnamed female client, which included that the client end her marriage and, that instead of following the treatment plan, the client had terminated services.
9. In response, C.G. told Respondent that a therapist should not pressure a client to terminate a relationship.
10. At a subsequent supervision session, Respondent told C.G. that he had informed two separate clients that they needed to "shit or get off the pot."
11. C.G. informed Respondent that this was not an appropriate way to speak with clients.
12. During a supervision meeting on an unknown date, Respondent told C.G. that he had instructed an unnamed male client to seek out the services of a sex worker as Respondent believed the client's lack of sexual experience was the root of the client's psychological issues.
13. On December 5, 2024, C.G. met with Respondent to address a complaint made by a female client regarding her November 6, 2024 psychotherapy appointment with Respondent.
14. In the meeting, Respondent told C.G. that, after the client mentioned the first sexual encounter she had with her child's father, he had followed up with detailed questions about the sex, such as whether the sex was oral or intercourse and whether the client or her then-partner had orgasmed.
15. Respondent did not document the sexual disclosures or his questions in his note for the December 5, 2024 session.
16. Respondent was terminated from the Agency in January 2025.

Violation One: 3 V.S.A. §129a(b)(1) Failure to practice competently by reason of any cause on a single occasion or on multiple occasions may constitute unprofessional conduct, whether actual injury to a client, patient, or customer has occurred. Failure to practice competently includes: performance of unsafe or unacceptable patient or client care.

17. Paragraphs 2 through 16 above are incorporated herein.
18. Paragraphs 2 through 16 demonstrate that Respondent failed to practice competently by performance of unsafe or unacceptable client care when Respondent directed a client to terminate a relationship, told two clients to "shit or get off the pot," directed a client to pay for sex, and asked a client detailed

questions about a sexual encounter without documenting any therapeutic purpose or the sexual disclosures.

19. The act(s), omission(s), and/or circumstance(s) described above constitute grounds for discipline because Respondent committed unprofessional conduct in violation of 3 V.S.A. §129a(b)(1).

Violation Two: 3 V.S.A. §129a(b)(2) Failure to practice competently by reason of any cause on a single occasion or on multiple occasions may constitute unprofessional conduct, whether actual injury to a client, patient, or customer has occurred. Failure to practice competently includes: failure to conform to the essential standards of acceptable and prevailing practice.

20. Paragraphs 2 through 16 above are incorporated herein.

21. Under Rule 6.6 of the Administrative Rules of the Board of Allied Mental Health Practitioners, the Board may rely on the American Counseling Association (ACA) Code of Ethics for acceptable standards of practice.

22. The ACA's Code of Ethics, A.1.a. provides: "The primary responsibility of counselors is to respect the dignity and promote the welfare of clients."

23. The ACA's Code of Ethics, A.4.b. provides: "Counselors are aware of—and avoid imposing—their own values, attitudes, beliefs, and behaviors. Counselors respect the diversity of clients . . . and seek training in areas in which they are at risk of imposing their values onto clients, especially when the counselor's values are inconsistent with the client's goals or are discriminatory in nature."

24. Paragraphs 2 through 16 demonstrate that Respondent failed to practice competently by failing to respect the dignity and promote the welfare of his clients and by imposing his own values, attitudes, and beliefs on his clients, specifically, when Respondent directed a client to terminate a relationship, told two clients to "shit or get off the pot," directed a client to pay for sex, and asked a client detailed questions about a sexual encounter without documenting any therapeutic purpose or the sexual disclosures.

25. The act(s), omission(s), and/or circumstance(s) described above constitute grounds for discipline because Respondent committed unprofessional conduct in violation of 3 V.S.A. §129a(b)(2).

Violation Three: 3 V.S.A. §129a(a)(28) Engaging in conduct of a character likely to deceive, defraud, or harm the public.

26. Paragraphs 2 through 16 above are incorporated herein.

27. Paragraphs 2 through 16 demonstrate that Respondent engaged in conduct of a character likely to deceive, defraud, or harm the public when directed a client to terminate a relationship, told two clients to "shit or get off the pot," directed a client to pay for sex, and asked a client detailed questions about a sexual

encounter without documenting any therapeutic purpose or the sexual disclosures.

28. The act(s), omission(s), and/or circumstance(s) described above constitute grounds for discipline because Respondent committed unprofessional conduct in violation of 3 V.S.A. §129a(a)(28).

Understandings

29. This Stipulation is neither an admission of liability by Respondent nor a concession by the State of Vermont that its charges are not well-founded. To avoid delay, uncertainty, inconvenience, and the expense of protracted litigation, the Parties enter this full and final Stipulation pursuant to these Understandings and the Order below. Respondent does not dispute that the State may be able to prove these charges by a preponderance of the evidence if this matter proceeds to a merits hearing. Respondent agrees the Order below is necessary to protect the public.
30. Respondent understands that the Board must review and accept the terms of the Consent Order. If the Board rejects any portion, the entire Stipulation and Consent Order shall be null and void.
31. Respondent specifically waives any claim that any disclosures made to the Board during review of this agreement have prejudiced Respondent's right to a fair and impartial hearing if this agreement is not accepted and proceeds to a hearing on the merits before the same Board.
32. Respondent has read and reviewed this entire document and agrees it contains the entire agreement between the parties.
33. Respondent is not under the influence of any drugs or alcohol at the time of signing this Stipulation and Consent Order.
34. Respondent voluntarily enters into this agreement after the opportunity to consult with legal counsel and is not being coerced by anyone into signing this Stipulation and Consent Order.
35. Respondent voluntarily waives the right to a contested hearing before the Board and waives any right to appeal from this Stipulation and Consent Order.
36. Respondent understands that he responsible for all compliance costs associated with this Stipulation and Consent Order.
37. Respondent agrees the Board/ALO may enter the Order set forth below.

Order

Based on the Stipulation above, it is **ORDERED AND ADJUDGED** as follows:

- A. The Board of Allied Mental Health Practitioners hereby **WARNS** Respondent's LCMHC and LMFT licenses.

B. The Board hereby **CONDITIONS** Respondent's LCMHC and LMFT licenses for a **MINIMUM OF twelve (12) MONTHS, commencing on the date of entry.** The **CONDITIONS** shall apply to each license and be as follows:

1. Re-issuance of License. Upon the commencement of these conditions and the renewal of Respondent's license, if expired, Respondent shall be issued a license labeled "conditioned."
2. Length of Time of Conditions Imposed. The conditions shall remain in place until Respondent has completed all conditions as ordered. Respondent shall be subject to the conditions until Respondent completes a minimum of one (1) year of supervised practice in which Respondent works at least sixty (60) hours per month as a LCMHC and LMFT. Part-time hours of fewer than sixty (60) hours every month shall be credited on a prorated basis. Respondent shall be prohibited from working more than forty (40) hours per week and shall verify hours worked on forms provided by the Case Manager.
3. Monitoring. The Office of Professional Regulation, through the Enforcement Case Manager, shall be responsible for monitoring Respondent's compliance with these Conditions. All reports and/or correspondence regarding compliance with these conditions shall be submitted to the Case Manager in accordance with the Conditions listed below.
4. Notification to Employers/Educational Programs. Respondent shall provide a copy of this Stipulation and Consent Order to all employers in any current or future setting in which Respondent practices the profession and inform them of Respondent's conditional license status. Within ten (10) days of the date of entry of this Consent Order or of any subsequent employment in the profession, Respondent shall cause Respondent's immediate supervisor to submit to the Case Manager an employer agreement form, acknowledging receipt of the Stipulation and Consent Order and the ability to comply with the conditions in the Consent Order.

In the event Respondent is attending an educational program which has a clinical portion that involves actual patient care, Respondent shall provide a copy of the Stipulation and Consent Order to the Program Director. Respondent shall cause the Program Director to submit to the Case Manager a program agreement form provided by the Case Manager, acknowledging receipt of the Stipulation and Consent Order and the ability of the program to comply with the conditions in the Consent Order during the clinical experience.

5. Practice Under Supervision. Respondent's practice as a LCMHC and LMFT shall be supervised by a pre-approved LCMHC or other licensed and pre-approved mental health practitioner licensed and in good standing in Vermont with more than ten [10] years of practice experience. In the event Respondent is not employed by an agency that can provide such supervision, Respondent shall, at his own expense, engage a pre-approved supervisor (Supervisor), who is a Vermont-licensed LCMHC or other licensed

and pre-approved mental health practitioner with more than ten [10] years of practice experience, to provide supervision regarding profession-specific issues or concerns that arise in Respondent's practice, bearing in mind applicable rules and regulations regarding patient/client privacy. Supervision must include discussions about boundaries, ethics, and documentation, as well as the rationale for practice decisions. The pre-approved Supervisor shall provide monthly reports to the Case Manager identifying when each supervision meeting occurred, how long it lasted, and generally identifying the profession-specific issues discussed. The Supervisor shall also report any ethical violations or standards of practice problems.

Respondent's consultation with the Supervisor shall take place no less than once per week by videoconference (or similar) or in person for a minimum of six (6) months. After six (6) months and upon the written recommendation of the Supervisor, Respondent may petition the Board for consultation to take place no less than once every other week by videoconference (or similar) or in person. The Supervisor's written recommendation must be sent directly to the Case Manager and explain the rationale behind the recommendation.

For pre-approval of the Supervisor, Respondent shall, within thirty (30) days, be responsible for locating a Supervisor willing and able to supervise per the requirements of this Order and provide the proposed supervisor with a copy of this Order. Respondent shall send the name, contact information, credentials, and curriculum vitae of the proposed Supervisor to the Enforcement Case Manager as part of the pre-approval process. If the Supervisor is not approved, Respondent shall repeat the process of locating a proposed supervisor and providing him/her this Order and sending the required information to the Case Manager for pre-approval.

6. Required Coursework. Respondent shall, within ninety (90) days following the entry of this Order, at his own expense, complete six [6] hours of pre-approved courses, which must include the following topics: Ethics and Risk Assessment. For pre-approval, Respondent must submit to the Case Manager the name of each course, the name of the sponsoring organization, and a description of the course content and/or syllabus. Respondent must achieve a passing score on the post-tests for the courses, and submit test results, workbooks completed in full and in a satisfactory manner, and certificates of completion to the Office of Professional Regulation.

Failure to complete the courses within the prescribed timeframe shall constitute a violation of this Order. The coursework may not be counted toward any continuing education requirement of licensure.

7. Interview with the Board or its Designee. Respondent shall appear in person for interviews with the Board or its designee upon request.
8. Out-of-State Practice. Before any out-of-state practice can be credited toward fulfillment of these terms and conditions, Respondent shall first obtain approval from the Board or its designee. The Board will approve out-of-state practice provided Respondent can still comply with the requirements of this

Consent Order. If Respondent receives discipline on a professional license held in another state during the conditioned period, Respondent must inform the Board of such, in writing, within ten (10) days of receiving such discipline.

9. Notification of Place of Employment/Personal Address/Telephone Number. Within ten (10) days of the date of entry of this Consent Order, Respondent shall notify the Board, in writing, of Respondent's current place of employment, personal address, and telephone number. Respondent shall further notify the Board, in writing, within forty-eight (48) hours of any change in employment (including resignation or termination), personal address, or telephone number.

10. Notification to Other States. In the event Respondent holds a professional license in any other state(s), Respondent must inform the licensing board of the state(s) in which Respondent is licensed of the conditional status of Respondent's Vermont license within thirty (30) days of the date of entry of this Order.

11. License Renewal. This Order does not automatically extend the license and Respondent must comply with the requirements for license renewal.

12. Costs. Respondent shall bear all costs of complying with this Consent Order.

13. Violation of this Order. If Respondent violates this Order, the Board, after giving Respondent notice and an opportunity to be heard, may rescind or modify this Order and impose additional appropriate disciplinary actions. If a complaint of unprofessional conduct is made against Respondent during the term of this Order, this Order shall be automatically extended until the unprofessional conduct matter is resolved.

14. Completion of Conditional License Period. Respondent shall submit a petition to the Docket Clerk to remove any and all conditions from Respondent's license. The State will support or oppose Respondent's petition. The Board will conduct a hearing if necessary. Respondent bears the burden and must present proof that Respondent has fully complied with the terms of this Order and these conditions are no longer necessary to protect the public.

C. Pursuant to 3 V.S.A. § 125(b)(11), a Disciplinary Action Surcharge in the amount of two-hundred and fifty dollars (\$250.00) is assessed against Respondent. Respondent shall remit payment within six (6) months of the date of entry of this Order. Payment of the surcharge may be on a payment plan if needed. Failure to remit payment may result in the non-renewal of Respondent's license/registration.

D. Notwithstanding any provision above, the Respondent must continue to meet all requirements for maintaining a license, license renewal and license reinstatement.

- E. This Stipulation and Consent Order is a matter of public record and may be reported to other licensing authorities as provided in 3 V.S.A. § 129(a).
- F. This Stipulation and Consent Order applies to all licenses this Board issues to Respondent, including future licenses, as provided in 3 V.S.A. § 129(l).
- G. This Stipulation and Consent Order will remain part of Respondent's licensing file and may be used for purposes of determining sanctions in any future disciplinary matter.

AGREED TO:

Dated: 9/9/26

**STATE OF VERMONT
SECRETARY OF STATE**

Zoe Newman
Zoe Newman
Prosecuting Attorney

Dated: 9/9/26

Respondent
Steven Quintiliani
Steven Quintiliani

Dated: 9/9/26

Counsel for Respondent
Ed Adrian, Esq.

APPROVED AND SO ORDERED:

Vermont Board Allied Mental Health

Dated: 9/17/2026

Signed by:
W. J. Kelly LCNHC
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Chairperson

Date of Entry: 9/17/26

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17. The State re-alleges and incorporates Paragraphs 2 through 16 above.
18. Paragraphs 2 through 16 demonstrate that Respondent failed to practice competently by performance of unsafe or unacceptable client care when Respondent directed a client to terminate a relationship, told two clients to "shit or get off the pot," directed a client to pay for sex, and asked a client detailed questions about a sexual encounter without documenting any therapeutic purpose or the sexual disclosures.

STATE OF VERMONT



Prosecuting Attorney
Office of
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Relief Requested

WHEREFORE, the State of Vermont respectfully requests that the Board revoke, suspend, condition, or otherwise discipline Respondent's Clinical Mental Health Counselor license.

DATED February 10, 2026

STATE OF VERMONT
SECRETARY OF STATE

By:

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STATE OF VERMONT



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